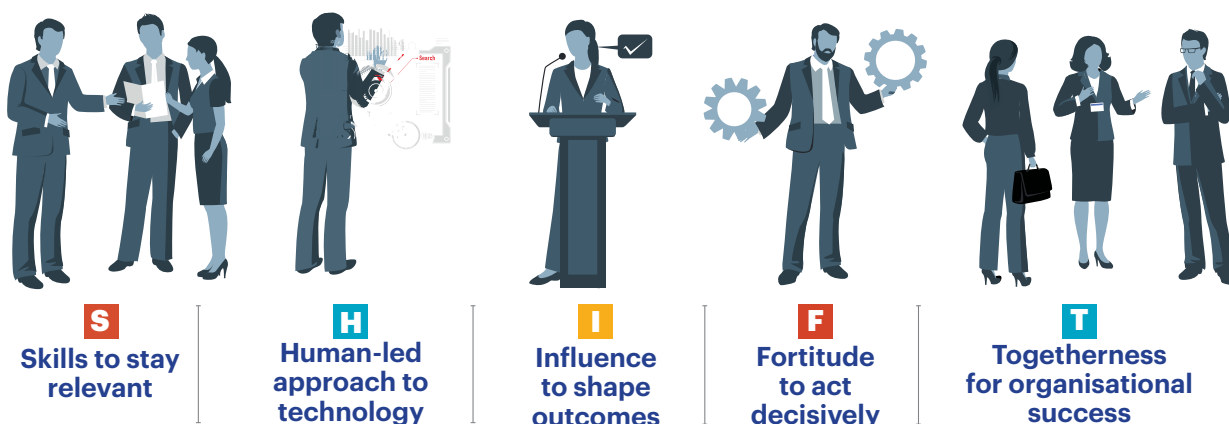


THE “SHIFT” MINDSET



help leaders understand the kind of talent needed for the future not just manage the present.”

Lakshmi Chandrasekharan, Senior Managing Director and CHRO, Accenture in India, highlights that the biggest opportunity for CHROs lies in fundamentally rethinking how work itself is designed in an AI-driven world.

She explains that the starting point is to move beyond existing structures and redesign work by deconstructing jobs into tasks—identifying where human judgment, creativity, and empathy add unique value, and where AI can augment. According to her, work redesign must be the priority.

Organisations can enable their workforce to continuously learn, unlearn, and relearn at scale.

Chandrasekharan also highlights the importance of bridging the human-AI integration gap. She believes that by equipping people with AI tools and training, organisations can encourage responsible experimentation, drive adoption, and build a culture where people thrive with AI.

Chandrasekharan, on the other hand, says CHROs must adopt what she refers to as the SHIFT mindset—building **Skills** to stay relevant, taking a **Human-led** approach to technology, leading with **Influence**, showing **Fortitude**, and achieving success **Together**.

This shift is already taking shape in practice.

Citing an example of her own company, Aarti Srivastava, Chief Human Resources Officer—India, Capgemini, says, “At Capgemini, HR works closely

with business leaders to anticipate capability needs, embed continuous learning, and ensure that talent strategies evolve in step with technological innovation and client demands.”

Looking ahead, organisations are increasingly relying on forward-looking indicators such as skills readiness, learning agility, and internal mobility to assess resilience. “These metrics provide deeper insight into how prepared the workforce is for future opportunities and help ensure that talent strategies remain aligned with the pace of technological change,” Srivastava notes.

FROM RISK ANTICIPATION TO BUSINESS READINESS

The CHRO’s role must evolve from managing people processes to anticipating and mitigating talent risks before they impact business outcomes.

“A key shift is combining data with behavioural insight, while analytics provides direction, understanding people dynamics enables meaningful action,” says Niren Srivastava, Group CHRO, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd. He points out that while culture is often underestimated, it demands the highest level of attention from HR leadership.

Srivastava emphasises that for CHROs to truly shape business strategy, they must focus on anticipation and readiness. “There is a never-before-seen need to continuously diagnose skill shortages and fix them—either by buying or building talent,” he says, adding that while AI may evolve, the constant remains the ability to iden-